



Loneliness from Passive Friendship Dissolution in Young Adults

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HCI RESEARCH

RELATIONSHIP SCIENCE

MOTIVATION 1

《Friends》 Doorbell Friends

沒打電話、沒約、看到燈亮就晃進來，隨時都能敲門的自在關係關係。

- 彼此不打擾卻隨時在身邊，有種理所當然的陪伴感。
- 沉默也不尷尬，各自忙著生活卻總能在轉身時看見對方。





MOTIVATION 2

Friendship dissolution without conflict

在沒有衝突的情況下，隨著生活、選擇、目標改變，關係逐漸疏離，產生一種缺乏明確原因卻持續存在的孤獨感。

- 例如：因教育體制與人生階段的轉換（如分班、升學）被迫進入不同生活軌跡，缺乏持續共享的環境，使關係逐漸疏離。



MOTIVATION 3

Social Media's Shifting Dynamics

IG 等社群媒體偏向個人經營

推播 + 索求回應，沒有共同感。

MOTIVATION 4

The Power of Shared Spaces

透過 shared-space，真正讓我們連結

讓連結能真正等於親近感



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TODO: "Why share space?" and What elements are required in it so that we may mitigate this friendship dissolution/ bond people more?



THE PROBLEM

We Aim to Explore

How to deal with loneliness from
Passive Friendship Dissolution in
Young Adults (18-30y) ?

RELATIVE WORKS

What is Passive Friendship Dissolution?

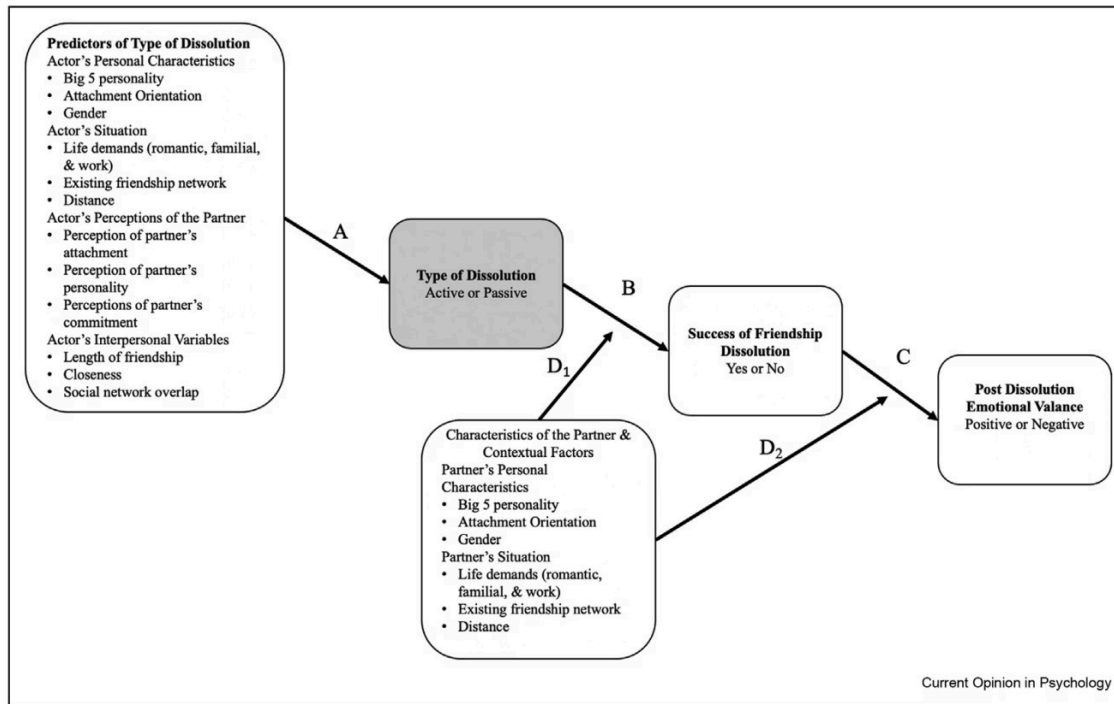
Passive friendship dissolution is the gradual, unstructured ending of a friendship **without confrontation** or **explicit breakup conversation**.

(Vieth G, Rothman AJ, Simpson JA. Friendship loss and dissolution in adulthood: A conceptual model. Curr Opin Psychol. 2022)

Find the right person for your vibe "

Pyg-000

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The Adult Friendship Dissolution Process Model suggests that passive dissolution is shaped by a combination of the actor's **personal traits** (e.g., attachment style, personality), **situational pressures** (e.g., distance, life demands), and **perceptions of the friend's likely response**, which together steer the actor toward gradually reducing contact rather than openly ending the friendship.

Why **loneliness** from Passive Friendship Dissolution Research Matters 1

WHAT

Peak vulnerability period

Loneliness **peaks at 18–30** during identity formation and network disruption.

(Barreto et al., Loneliness around the world: Age, gender, and cultural differences in loneliness. Pers Individ Dif. 2021)

Shapes lifelong relational capacity

Young adult friendships **build intimacy skills** for all future relationships.

(Rawlins WK. Friendship matters: Communication, dialectics, and the life course. Routledge. 2017)

SO WHAT

If young adults internalize that "relationships naturally fade," they enter adulthood unable to commit, fearing investment in any bond that requires sustained effort.

Why loneliness from **Passive Friendship Dissolution** Research Matters 2

WHAT

Invisible to current interventions

Drift **causes no immediate distress to trigger help-seeking**, while subsequent loneliness triggers withdrawal instead of outreach.

(Vieth et al., 2022; Cacioppo et al., 2015)

High prevalence, few solutions

73% of Gen Z report feeling lonely "sometimes or always," but modern tech leaves **friendship drift** unsolved.

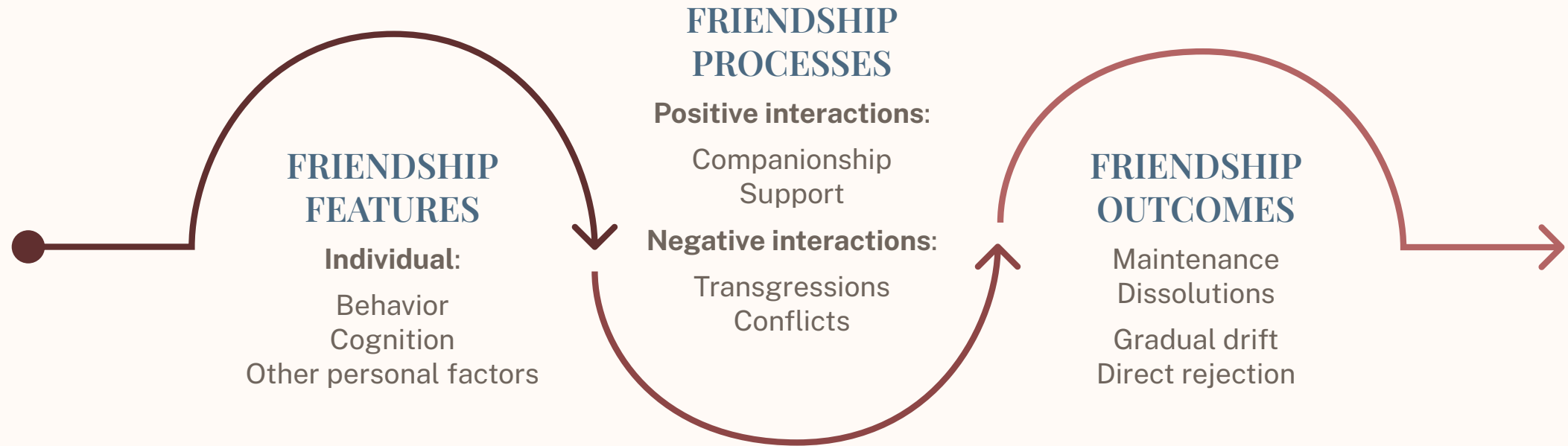
(Cigna Loneliness Index, 2020)

SO WHAT

Young adults are stuck in a self-blaming loneliness loop that looks like personal failure but is actually a mass-scale system failure. Because drift is invisible, few solutions help to solve it.

To understand why this is difficult to solve,
we first examine how friendships work.

What is the mechanism of friendship



Santucci, K., Dirks, M. A., & Lydon, J. E. (2025). With or without you: Understanding friendship dissolution from childhood through young adulthood. Journal of Social and Personal Relationships, 42(1), 3-31.

So, why is it hard to solve?

Researchers have mapped *who's at risk* and *what outcomes look like*,
but **haven't yet identified** *the specific daily interaction patterns* that cause passive drift.
(Santucci et al., 2025; Hansen et al., 2025)



Hard to design interventions for processes we can't see.

Existing Solutions Miss the Mark

Current HCI Interventions Target:

Social isolation
making **NEW** friends

Clinical loneliness
psychological
treatment

Breadth over depth
follower counts, group chats

What's Missing:

Tools for
MAINTAINING
existing close bonds

Systems for **DEPTH**
across distance

Making **DRIFT** visible before irreversible

Current HCI Solution Failing

WHAT

Making "NEW" friends, an paradox

These platforms prioritize the "match" but ignore the 200+ hours of **shared time required to develop a deep bond**.

(Hall, 2018)

Treatment lack of mutual vulnerability

AI agents can provide comfort but cannot offer the **feeling of "being needed" by another** — which is the foundation of a true close bond.

(Ta et al., 2020)

SO WHAT

If current solutions only offer "social snacks" instead of "emotional nutrition," young adults remain socially malnourished — mistaking the convenience of swiping and AI chatting for the hard-won resilience of authentic human bonds.

Takeaway

Motivate

Adulthood transitions cause conflict-free, passive friendship drift and loneliness.

Why matters

Network disruption at 18–30 damages lifelong capacity for intimacy.

Hard to solve

Drift is invisible; tech prioritizes new connections over maintenance.

Our future exploration

How can HCI make drift visible and restore intimacy?